Weekly cetuximab + head and neck radiotherapy

Cetuximab is combined with radiotherapy for selected locally advanced head and neck cancer when platinum chemotherapy is unsuitable. The team discusses the reason for choosing this treatment and the alternatives.

Locally advanced squamous head and neck cancer in people ineligible for platinum-based treatment. · NCCP 00207 v6 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Locally advanced squamous head and neck cancer in people ineligible for platinum-based treatment.

My overall treatment

First dose 1 week before radiation; then weekly until radiation ends.

7 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Cetuximab infusion — Day 1

Cetuximab before radiotherapy
Cetuximab 400 mg/m² over 120 minutes, with prescribed premedication, monitoring and observation.

Weekly cetuximab with radiotherapy
Cetuximab 250 mg/m² over 60 minutes every week while radiotherapy continues. The team coordinates the final dose with the radiation plan.

Recovery and mineral checks
NCCP specifies monthly electrolytes, magnesium and calcium for two months after the final cetuximab dose; continue mouth, skin, swallowing and nutrition care as needed.

A typical 7-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–7
Cetuximab visit	Care between weekly visits

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline safety and preparation** NCCP / radiation plan	Blood count, kidneys/liver and minerals; allergy review. Dental and radiation preparation.
During	**Bloods and symptoms** NCCP	Regular bloods and mineral checks; infusion observation, skin, eyes and radiation review.
After / response	**Follow-up and tests** NCCP / individual plan	Mineral tests monthly for 2 months after last dose. Continue radiation recovery and individual scan plan.

Between treatments

- Radiation has its own appointment calendar; mouth, skin and swallowing effects may build across weeks.
- Keep drinking and nutrition support active; seek help before intake or weight falls substantially.

Bring your medicine list, test dates, treatment calendar and actual urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Eyes

Cetuximab

Report eye pain, redness, light sensitivity or visual change promptly.

2 Mouth / swallowing

Head and neck radiotherapy

Mouth sores, dry mouth, thick saliva or swallowing pain can affect drinking and nutrition; ask for early help.

3 Infusion reaction

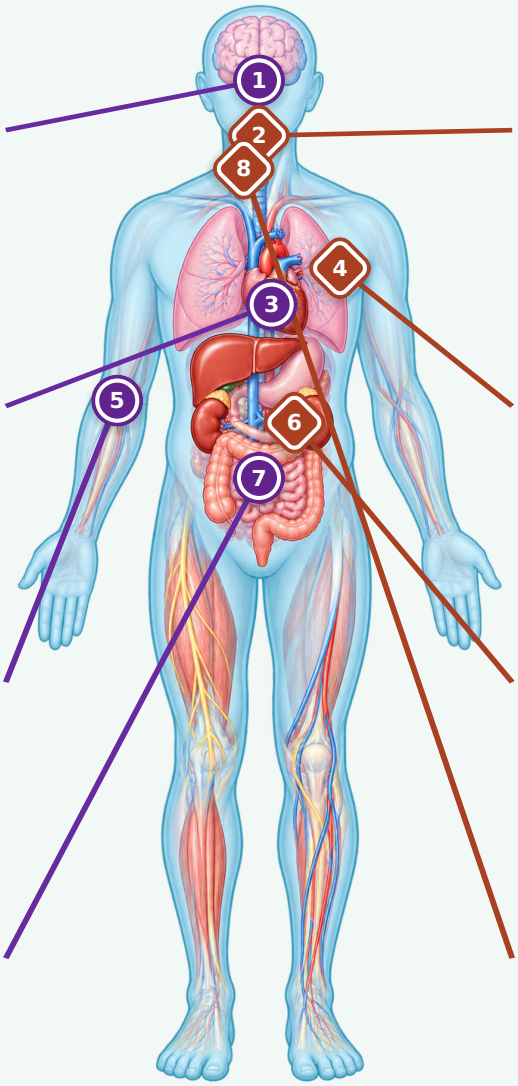
Cetuximab

Tell staff immediately about flushing, itching, swelling, wheeze or faintness; reactions can also occur after leaving.

4 Lungs / breathing

Cetuximab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment. Severe breathing difficulty is an emergency.



5 Skin / nails

Cetuximab + radiotherapy

Acne-like rash, cracked skin, painful nails or radiation skin breakdown need the agreed care plan and review.

6 Minerals / fluids

Cetuximab

Low magnesium and other minerals may show on blood tests. Report cramps, weakness, palpitations or dehydration.

7 Bowels

Cetuximab

Report diarrhoea, especially with dizziness, much less urine or difficulty drinking.

8 Teeth / jaw / nutrition

Head and neck radiotherapy

Continue dental and swallowing care. Report jaw stiffness, weight loss, choking or a mouth wound that does not heal.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Tell staff immediately about an infusion reaction. After leaving, seek urgent help for swelling, wheeze, faintness or breathing difficulty. Report spreading rash, infected nails, eye pain, visual change, severe diarrhoea or inability to drink. Mouth and skin effects from radiation may continue after its final session.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

Keep your treatment details to hand

Locally advanced squamous head and neck cancer in people ineligible for platinum-based treatment. · NCCP 00207 v6 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Cetuximab + radiotherapy (RT)

First dose 1 week before radiation; then weekly until radiation ends.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678
Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling weekly record through the radiation course.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.